

What Is a Problem Statement?

A **problem statement** is a clear, concise description of **a problem that needs to be solved**. It explains the current situation, what is wrong or inefficient about it, who is affected, and why solving it matters.

What a Good Problem Statement Answers

- **What is the problem?**
- **Who is affected by the problem?**
- **What is causing or contributing to it?**
- **What impact does the problem have?**
- **Why does the problem need to be addressed?**

A problem statement should generally describe the **problem itself**, not jump immediately to the solution.

Example: Corporate Policy AI Assistant

Weak problem statement:

Employees need an AI chatbot to search corporate policies.

This already assumes the solution is an AI chatbot.

Stronger problem statement:

Employees often have difficulty locating accurate and relevant information within a large collection of corporate policy documents. Policy information may be distributed across multiple documents and repositories, requiring employees to manually search and interpret lengthy content. This can increase the time required to answer policy-related questions, create inconsistent interpretations, and reduce employee productivity.

From that problem statement, you can later introduce the **Corporate Policy AI Assistant** as the proposed solution.

Simple Way to Distinguish the Terms

Overview = What is this project or system?

Problem Statement = What problem are we trying to solve?

Solution = How are we going to solve the problem?